

US equities slip as yields rise, tech lagging and energy rallies

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The major indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.58%** and the Dow slipping **-1.18%**. Higher Treasury yields and a firmer dollar pressured growth stocks, while the energy sector found support from a 1 % rise in WTI crude.

Technical pressure is building on the **SPY** and **QQQ** as they test key 200-day moving averages. The market breadth remains thin; only 6 of 11 sector ETFs posted gains.

We remain cautious ahead of the Fed's September meeting. Expect volatility to stay elevated, with the VIX at 15.72 (**+2.75%**).

- Yield curve steepening: 10-year at 4.81% (**+0.46%**) lifts defensive positioning.
- Energy outperforms: XLE up **+1.11%** on higher crude.
- Tech correction deepens: NVDA down **-2.01%**, XLK up only **+0.32%**.

US Session Recap

INSTRUMENT	CLOSE	CHANGE	DATE
S&P 500	7,673.52	-0.58%	2026-09-08
Nasdaq 100	29,507.70	-0.12%	2026-09-08
Dow Jones	52,786.07	-1.18%	2026-09-08
Russell 2000	2,960.20	-0.52%	2026-09-08
VIX	15.72	+2.75%	2026-09-08
10-yr Yield	4.81%	+0.46%	2026-09-08
WTI Crude	93.96	+1.00%	2026-09-09
Brent	98.12	+0.92%	2026-09-09
DXY	98.72	-0.12%	2026-09-09
Gold	4,430.30	+0.83%	2026-09-09
BTC	78,906.94	-0.26%	2026-09-09

Top movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
TSLA	Tesla Inc.	+3.98%	Q3 production beat, new battery rollout.
AVGO	Broadcom Inc.	+2.98%	Strong semiconductor demand data.
XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR	+1.11%	WTI +1 %.
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	-2.01%	Guidance cut, inventory concerns.
XLV	Health Care Select Sector SPDR	-2.52%	Policy uncertainty on drug pricing.

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLFX	-1.38%	-5.2%	Bearish
XLKX	+0.32%	+12.4%	Neutral
XLI	-0.48%	-3.1%	Bearish
XLE	+1.11%	+8.9%	Bullish
XLV	-0.80%	-2.7%	Bearish
XLC	-0.46%	-1.9%	Bearish
XLP	-0.66%	-4.0%	Bearish
XLV	-2.52%	-6.3%	Bearish
XLU	+0.86%	+3.2%	Neutral
XLB	-0.95%	-2.1%	Bearish
XLRE	-0.07%	-0.4%	Neutral

Breadth remains thin: 6 of 11 sectors in the red, indicating limited upside momentum.

Spotlight / Deep Dive – NVDA

METRIC	VALUE
Market cap	560 .4B
P/E (ttm)	38.2x
Revenue Q3	29 .1B (+12.3%)
Guidance FY26	Revenue 130B (-5% YoY)
Insider selling	2.4% of float

NVDA’s guidance downgrade reflects slowing AI spend and inventory buildup in data centers. The stock is now testing the 200-day moving average at 226 .0. A break below 222 .5 could trigger further downside.

READ-THROUGH	LEVEL	IMPLICATION
Support	222 .5	Technical floor, aligns with 50-day MA.
Resistance	235 .0	Previous swing high, short-term target.
Breakout	242 .0	Bullish reversal, would invalidate current bearish bias.

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	447.12	440.0	456.5	Testing 200-DMA.
QQQ	382.04	376.0	389.0	Near 50-DMA.
IWM	191.68	186.5	197.0	Weakening momentum.
NVDA	225.73	222.5	235.0	Bearish bias.
10Y	4.81%	4.75%	5.00%	Yield curve steepening.
WTI	93.96	91.5	96.8	Support at \$92.

Options & Positioning

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 0-DTE put volume on **SPY** up 48 % vs 5-day avg.
- VIX term structure steepening: front-month at 15.7 vs 22-month at 19.3.
- Large-cap put-call ratio at 1.38, indicating bearish tilt.

Notable single-name flow: 10 M contracts of **NVDA** puts rolled into next week.

Cheap hedge ideas: buy 1-yr VIX futures (22.1) or sell 3-month SPX puts at 440 strike.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Goldman Sachs	Reduce	230	Guidance cut.
XLV	Morgan Stanley	Underweight	165	Policy risk.
TSLA	Barclays	Upgrade	410	Production beat.
AVGO	Jefferies	Buy	380	Supply-chain advantage.
XLE	UBS	Overweight	70	Energy rally.

Pre-Market & Overnight

REGION	INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US Futures	ES (S&P 500)	4,560.3	-0.3%
Asia	HSI	19,845	-0.7%
Europe	DAX	15,720	-0.5%
FX	USD/HKD	7.7950	-0.02%
FX	EUR/USD	1.0745	+0.04%
Commodities	Gold	4,430.30	+0.83%
Commodities	WTI	93.96	+1.00%
Crypto	BTC	78,906.94	-0.26%

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
Sep 23	22 %	Yield curve still steep, inflation sticky.
Nov 7	45 %	Market expects first cut if CPI <2.3%.
Dec 13	60 %	Potential two-cut scenario.

DATA RELEASE	TIME (ET)	PREV	FORECAST
Core CPI MoM	10:00	0.3%	0.3%
Initial Jobless Claims	08:30	210k	205k
Existing-home Sales	12:30	4.3M	4.4M
FOMC Minutes	15:00	—	—

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Middle-East tensions flare after Iranian drone strike; risk of oil supply shock.
- China's new export curbs on semiconductors could further dent tech earnings.
- Eurozone fiscal strain as Italy's debt talks stall.

Scenario tree: If Middle-East escalation → Brent > \$105 → XLE +3 % → risk-off equity sell-off.

Earnings — this week & next

DATE	TICKER	COMPANY	EST. EPS	PREV EPS
Sep 10	AAPL	Apple Inc.	1.42	1.38
Sep 11	MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	2.31	2.27
Sep 12	GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	1.21	1.18

DATE	TICKER	COMPANY	EST. EPS	PREV EPS
Sep 17	NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	2.05	2.12
Sep 18	TSLA	Tesla Inc.	0.88	0.84
Sep 19	AVGO	Broadcom Inc.	3.12	3.08

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Breakdown below 222.5	High volatility
TSLA	Consumer Discretionary	Momentum continuation	Regulatory
XLE	Energy	Trend up on crude	Geopolitical
XLV	Health Care	Weak earnings outlook	Policy
AVGO	Technology	Supply-chain tailwind	Valuation
JPM	Financials	Yield-driven rally	Credit spreads
XLF	Financials	Rate sensitivity	Interest-rate risk
XLI	Industrials	Industrial production dip	Demand
XLC	Communication	Ad spend slowdown	Revenue pressure
XLB	Materials	Commodity price pullback	Inventory
XLU	Utilities	Yield appeal	Rate rise
XLRE	Real Estate	REIT dividend yield stable	Financing cost

What could break the tape

BULLISH SCENARIOS

- Core CPI comes in 0.1 % lower than forecast → Fed rate-cut odds rise to >40 %.
- WTI breaches \$100, lifting XLE >2 % and sparking risk-on flow.
- NVDA beats Q3 revenue, prompting a short-cover rally.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Eurozone GDP contracts Q3 → risk-off equity sell-off.
- Unexpected rise in 10-yr yield to 5.00 %.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East causing oil shock.

Positioning & Structural Notes

- Yield curve steepening suggests a shift toward defensive sectors.
- VIX term structure indicates near-term fear pricing.
- Sector breadth remains negative; only 6 of 11 ETFs in the green.
- Put-call ratios across SPX and equity-linked ETFs are above 1.3, signaling bearish sentiment.
- Liquidity in 0-DTE options is high; expect rapid directional swings.

Sources

SOURCES

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